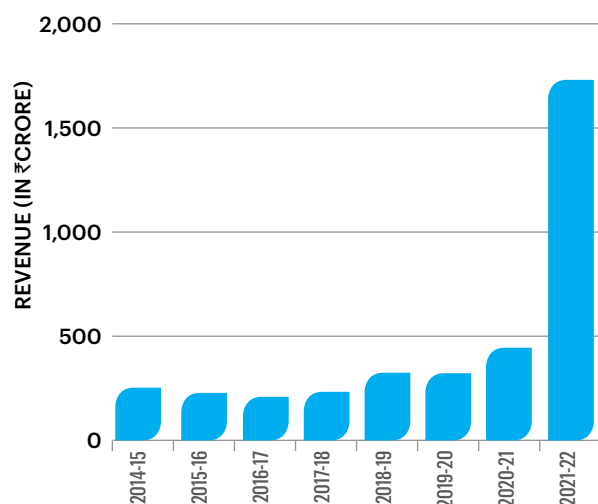


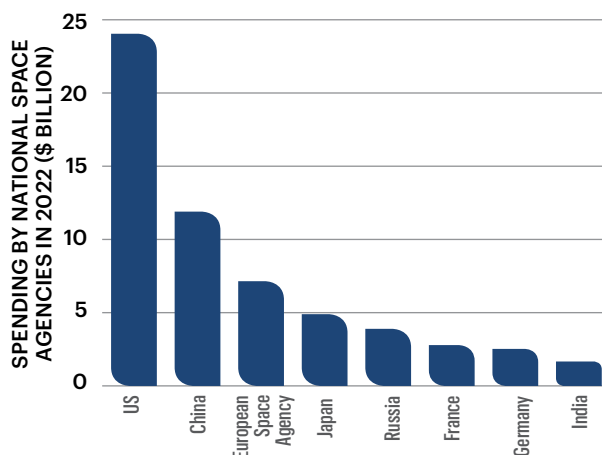
ZOOMING REVENUES

In FY22, NSIL's revenues jumped manifold to ₹1,713 crore



A LOW-COST PLAYER

The US is by far the biggest spender in the space sector



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▶ Since FY20, Isro sells its products to NSIL, which sells to other players

▶ Isro and NSIL come under DoS. Revenue till 2018-19 is for DoS

▶ Isro has one of the lowest budgets among its global peers

▶ At 0.05 per cent, India ranks seventh in space spending as a share of GDP

SOURCE DEPARTMENT OF SPACE (DOS), NSIL

SOURCE PUBLIC REPORTS, BT RESEARCH

after tax of ₹342.98 crore. Its revenue zoomed from ₹321.77 crore in FY20 to ₹1,731 crore in FY22.

Therefore, as part of the opening of the Indian space ecosystem to private participation since 2020, Isro is playing a key role in transforming the sector from a supply-based model to a demand-based one. It has already started helping with capacity building through the development of new technologies and capabilities, technology transfers to private players and sharing its facilities with NSIL and Non-Government Private Entities.

It is also making an all-out effort to retain India's position as a low-

cost yet reliable satellite launch services provider. And it aims to maintain this leadership position in the arena through the Small Satellite Launch Vehicle (SSLV) and a reusable rocket.

Ranjana Kaul, Partner at the New Delhi-based law firm Dua Associates, says India, as a late entrant to the global commercial space sector, has no time to spare in this highly competitive marketplace. "At one time, we had about a 2 per cent share of the international commercial space launch market. But when [Elon] Musk introduced his reusable SpaceX rocket bringing down the cost of a commercial space

launch significantly, India was no longer the cheapest," she says.

Therefore, even as the orbit economy booms, the cost of satellite launches continues to decline, and competition promises to get ever more cut-throat, the country remains in the reckoning.

The SSLV was conceived after increased demand for launch vehicles with a quick turnaround time to put small satellite constellations in the Lower Earth Orbit (LEO). It is an all-solid fuel-powered three-stage vehicle capable of launching mini, micro or nano class satellites in the 10-500 kg range. "The SSLV was created as an industry-friendly